

Copyright Basics

Learning Objectives

- Understand what copyright is and why it exists
- Recognize copyright symbols and their meaning
- Learn how to use copyrighted material legally

Engage (5-7 minutes)

A farmer's seeds are his own — others can't take them without permission. Copyright works the same way for creative work: books, music, art, and code belong to their creators, and others must ask permission to use them, like respecting a farmer's ownership of his harvest.

Explore (10-12 minutes)

Students identify copyrighted materials around them: textbooks, songs, movies, and software. They see the © symbol and learn it means "this work belongs to someone." Like recognizing property boundaries in the village, copyright marks creative ownership.

Explain (10-12 minutes)

Copyright gives creators exclusive rights to their work: to copy, distribute, perform, and modify it. The © symbol indicates copyright protection. Copyright exists automatically when work is created — no registration needed. Like a farmer's claim to his field, copyright protects creators' rights to their creative produce.

Elaborate (8-10 minutes)

Students learn about fair use: using small portions for education, criticism, or parody. Like borrowing a neighbor's tool for a day (acceptable) versus taking it permanently (not acceptable), fair use allows limited borrowing while respecting ownership.

Evaluate (5-8 minutes)

Can students explain what copyright protects? Can they identify the © symbol and its meaning? Do they understand the difference between using copyrighted material legally versus illegally?